

STRAWBERRY DREAM HAT

NINE SIZES, 44 TO 92



A round hat with a green scalloped edge, knitted-in seeds, green ear flaps with ties, and a green calyx of six sepals with an i-cord stalk on top. Graded in nine sizes, from small newborn up to two years.

44

small newborn / preemie

50

newborn, 0-1 mo

56

1-2 mo

62

2-4 mo

68

4-6 mo

74

6-9 mo

80

9-12 mo

86

12-18 mo

92

18-24 mo, 2 years



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Little Montessori Explorers

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Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. **Test knit version 1.0**

BEFORE YOU START

The hat is worked in the round from the bottom up. It begins with the green scalloped edge, and the rest of the hat is pink: body and crown. The seeds are knitted into the body. When the hat is finished, the calyx is worked as a separate piece in green, six pointed sepals round an i-cord stalk, and sewn over the top. Finally the green ear flaps are picked up in the green edge, decreased to a point, and the tie continues straight out of the point as an i-cord.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- working a scalloped edge with a green finish
- scattering single stitches in another colour without long floats
- decreasing a round crown in eight sections
- knitting pointed leaves decreased to a single stitch
- picking up ear flaps and decreasing them to a point
- knitting i-cord for both the stalk and the ties

DIFFICULTY

Easy. The hat is the quickest piece in the collection and a good place to start. It uses the same charts as the other pieces, but over so few stitches that a mistake is put right in minutes.

SIZES AND FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

The hat is graded in the same nine sizes as the rest of the collection, one hat per garment size. Measure the head where the hat will sit, round the forehead and over the ears, and choose by that measurement.

44

small newborn / preemie

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newborn, 0-1 mo

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62

2-4 mo

68

4-6 mo

74

6-9 mo

80

9-12 mo

86

12-18 mo

92

18-24 mo, 2 years

Size	Head circumference	Stitches round	Hat circumference	Height	Scallops	Leaf length
44	32,0 cm	56 sts	26,7 cm	11,5 cm	7 x	2,9 cm
50	35,0 cm	60 sts	28,6 cm	12,5 cm	10 x	2,9 cm
56	38,0 cm	63 sts	30,0 cm	13,5 cm	7 x	4,3 cm
62	41,0 cm	70 sts	33,3 cm	14,5 cm	10 x	4,3 cm
68	43,0 cm	72 sts	34,3 cm	15,3 cm	8 x	4,3 cm
74	45,0 cm	80 sts	38,1 cm	16,0 cm	10 x	5,7 cm
80	46,0 cm	81 sts	38,6 cm	16,5 cm	9 x	5,7 cm
86	47,0 cm	88 sts	41,9 cm	17,2 cm	11 x	5,7 cm
92	48,0 cm	90 sts	42,9 cm	17,8 cm	10 x	5,7 cm

The circumference is deliberately smaller than the head, so the hat sits close. Note that this hat has no rib: the scalloped edge stretches as the hat goes on, but it does not draw back in the way a rib does. It is the ties that hold the hat in place. So cast on very loosely.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	short circular, double-pointed or Magic Loop
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and sewing on the ties
Stitch markers	eight, to mark the sections in the crown

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
44	20 g	15 g	5 g
50	25 g	20 g	5 g
56	30 g	25 g	5 g
62	35 g	30 g	5 g
68	40 g	35 g	5 g
74	45 g	40 g	5 g
80	50 g	45 g	5 g
86	55 g	50 g	5 g
92	60 g	55 g	5 g

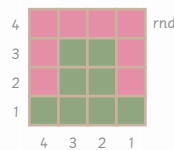
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means one needle size up, fewer means one down. The gauge decides every measurement here.

STRAWBERRY TOP AND SEEDS

The rounds are worked in the order they are numbered, round 1 first, and each round is read from right to left, the same way you knit. The strawberry top is 4 stitches and is repeated round. It is deliberately smaller than the leaf on the larger garments: on a mitten or a sock the large leaf would cover almost the whole surface.

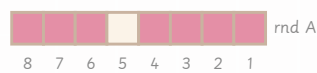
STRAWBERRY TOP, 4 STITCHES x 4 ROUNDS



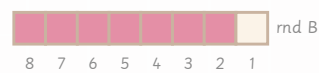
● leaf green ● strawberry pink ● cream white, one seed

SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches. On such a small area two seed rounds are enough: work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. The two rounds offset the seeds against each other.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

1 • THE SCALLOPED EDGE

The hat begins with the same edge as the rest of the collection, but here it comes first, since the hat is worked from the bottom up. Cast on very loosely in GREEN, join in the round without twisting the cast-on, and place a marker at the beginning of the round. Work 3 rounds in knit in green.

Change to pink. Divide the round into scallops with a marker between each. How many stitches the scallop is, and the numbers A and B, are in your column. Work the scallop round: *ssk, k A, M1R, k B, M1L, k A, k2tog*, and repeat round. If A is zero, you simply skip those stitches. The stitch count stays the same, but the edge shapes itself into rounded scallops. Repeat the scallop round 5 times in all, then continue straight up.

Size	Cast on	Scallops	Sts per scallop	A	B	Scallop rounds	Height of the edge
44	56 sts	7 x	8 sts	1	2	5	2,9 cm
50	60 sts	10 x	6 sts	0	2	5	2,9 cm
56	63 sts	7 x	9 sts	1	3	5	2,9 cm
62	70 sts	10 x	7 sts	0	3	5	2,9 cm
68	72 sts	8 x	9 sts	1	3	5	2,9 cm
74	80 sts	10 x	8 sts	1	2	5	2,9 cm
80	81 sts	9 x	9 sts	1	3	5	2,9 cm
86	88 sts	11 x	8 sts	1	2	5	2,9 cm
92	90 sts	10 x	9 sts	1	3	5	2,9 cm

The width of the scallop is not the same in every size, and that is deliberate. If all nine hats had to share one repeat, several sizes would have to share a stitch count, and then they are not nine sizes. The repeat is chosen instead from those that divide into your stitch count exactly. You only ever read the number in your own column.

2 · THE PINK SECTION AND SEEDS

Continue in pink stocking stitch in the round, that is knit on every round. On a seed round work *1 cream, the rest pink*, where the repeat is the stitch count in your column. Work 4 rounds in pink, then work the next seed round offset by half the repeat, so the seeds do not sit in vertical columns. Continue like that until the pink section measures the length in your column.

Size	Stitches	Pink section	Seed repeat	Seeds per round
44	56 sts	4,3 cm	8 sts	7 x
50	60 sts	6,0 cm	6 sts	10 x
56	63 sts	6,3 cm	9 sts	7 x
62	70 sts	7,3 cm	7 sts	10 x
68	72 sts	6,7 cm	9 sts	8 x
74	80 sts	6,7 cm	8 sts	10 x
80	81 sts	7,9 cm	9 sts	9 x
86	88 sts	7,2 cm	8 sts	11 x
92	90 sts	8,5 cm	9 sts	10 x

The hat has its own seed repeat for each size, just like the socks. The reason is the same: the stitch count is chosen so the hat fits the head, not so that a fixed chart comes out even. The repeat in your column divides exactly into your stitch count.

3 • SHAPING THE CROWN

All of this is worked in PINK. Divide the round into 8 equal sections and place a marker at each. The stitch count in every size is divisible by 8, so the sections come out even without adjustment. Then work as follows: a decrease round where you knit 2 together just before each marker, that is 8 stitches decreased, then 1 round in knit. Repeat until 8 stitches remain. The number of decrease rounds is in your column. Cut the yarn, draw it through the 8 stitches, tighten and fasten off on the inside.

Size	Start	Sections	Decrease rounds	Left after decreasing	Height of the crown
44	56 sts	8 x	6 x	8 sts	4,3 cm
50	60 sts	10 x	5 x	10 sts	3,6 cm
56	63 sts	9 x	6 x	9 sts	4,3 cm
62	70 sts	10 x	6 x	10 sts	4,3 cm
68	72 sts	8 x	8 x	8 sts	5,7 cm
74	80 sts	8 x	9 x	8 sts	6,4 cm
80	81 sts	9 x	8 x	9 sts	5,7 cm
86	88 sts	8 x	10 x	8 sts	7,1 cm
92	90 sts	9 x	9 x	9 sts	6,4 cm

Always decrease in the same place relative to the marker. The decreases then form eight clear lines up towards the top, and it is that line that makes a round hat look round rather than lopsided.

4 • THE CALYX AND ITS SEPALS

The calyx is a separate piece in green, worked from the top down: first the stalk, then the sepals. It is sewn over the top of the hat at the end.

- Cast on 3 stitches in green and work an i-cord until the stalk measures the length in your column.
- Increase evenly on the next round to the stitch count in your column, and divide the stitches into 6 equal sections. Each section is one sepal.
- Work each sepal separately, back and forth in stocking stitch: work 3 rows straight, then decrease 1 stitch at each side on every 4th row until 1 stitch remains. Draw the yarn through and fasten off.
- Repeat until all 6 sepals are done.

Size	Stalk stitches	Stalk	Increase to	Leaves	Sts per leaf	Decrease rows	Leaf length
44	3 sts	4 cm	30 sts	6 x	5 sts	2 x	2,9 cm
50	3 sts	4 cm	30 sts	6 x	5 sts	2 x	2,9 cm
56	3 sts	4 cm	42 sts	6 x	7 sts	3 x	4,3 cm
62	3 sts	5 cm	42 sts	6 x	7 sts	3 x	4,3 cm
68	3 sts	5 cm	42 sts	6 x	7 sts	3 x	4,3 cm
74	3 sts	5 cm	54 sts	6 x	9 sts	4 x	5,7 cm
80	3 sts	6 cm	54 sts	6 x	9 sts	4 x	5,7 cm
86	3 sts	6 cm	54 sts	6 x	9 sts	4 x	5,7 cm
92	3 sts	6 cm	54 sts	6 x	9 sts	4 x	5,7 cm

Sew the calyx down with small stitches along the base of the sepals, not along the points. That lets the sepals lie loosely out over the pink, the way they do on a strawberry, instead of being sewn down flat.

5 • THE EAR FLAPS AND THE TIES

The flaps are GREEN, and they hang straight down from the green edge. Pick up in green in the cast-on edge itself, one flap on each side. Find centre front and centre back, and place the flaps midway between them, that is right under where the ear sits. Pick up the number of stitches your column says.

- Work 4 rows in stocking stitch back and forth, in green.
- Then decrease 1 stitch at each side every other row, until 3 stitches remain.
- Work an i-cord in green on those 3 stitches until the tie measures the length in your column, and cast off. The tie therefore grows straight out of the point of the flap, it is not sewn on.
- Work the second flap exactly the same.

Size	Pick up per flap	Straight rows	Decrease rows	Height of the flap	Tie
44	11 sts	4	4 x	4,3 cm	22 cm
50	11 sts	4	4 x	4,3 cm	24 cm
56	13 sts	4	5 x	5,0 cm	25 cm
62	13 sts	4	5 x	5,0 cm	27 cm
68	13 sts	4	5 x	5,0 cm	28 cm
74	15 sts	4	6 x	5,7 cm	30 cm
80	15 sts	4	6 x	5,7 cm	31 cm
86	15 sts	4	6 x	5,7 cm	32 cm
92	15 sts	4	6 x	5,7 cm	33 cm

The ties are tied in a bow under the chin, never in a knot. Count the rows rather than measuring on the second flap, so the two come out the same length.

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the the hat is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Chest after washing

Time taken, roughly

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Total length after washing

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Ties must always be tied in a bow that comes undone if the child pulls at it, and the hat should be taken off when the child sleeps.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on children's garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. In the smallest sizes the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless, with a leaf yoke and flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper, with a round yoke and long sleeves.
- Strawberry Dream skirt, with a green rib at the waist and a scalloped hem.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a cord, sizes 44 to 74.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with ties at the ankle, sizes 44 to 92.
- Strawberry Dream hat, with a calyx and ear flaps, sizes 44 to 92.
- Strawberry Dream socks, with a heel flap and wedge toe, sizes 44 to 92.

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